

Recovering from Gaslighting

Trusting yourself again when you're made to doubt everything

4 psychology approaches · tips & resources — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Trusting yourself again when you're made to doubt everything

Gaslighting is manipulation that makes you doubt your own perception: 'you're making it up', 'I never said that', 'you're too sensitive', 'you're crazy'. Over time, you stop trusting your memory or your feelings. You're not the problem.

This guide helps you recognize gaslighting, rebuild trust in your own perception, and surround yourself with support to get out.

Your intention

A sentence repeated to you that makes you doubt yourself: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Why the doubt sets in

Gaslighting works through repetition: from hearing that you're wrong, that you exaggerate, your own judgment wavers. Sometimes old ground (having learned to doubt yourself) amplifies the effect.

Understanding the mechanism means no longer believing that 'you're the problem'.

Example

From hearing 'you're making it up', Tom stopped trusting his memory. Naming gaslighting helped him find his footing.

The doubt installed in me

What's repeated to you that makes you doubt your memory or your feelings?

My ground

Did I already tend to doubt myself? How did this relationship amplify it?

→ *The doubt was installed — it says nothing about my sanity.*

Rebuilding your perception

'I'm imagining things', 'I must be remembering wrong': these thoughts are the result of gaslighting. Writing the facts as they happen gives you back a reliable anchor.

Your notes become the witness you're being made to forget.

Example

Nia started noting exchanges right after. Rereading her notes cleared the fog.

Anchoring journal

Note a recent fact right after it happens (what was said/done, word for word if possible).

Facts vs doubt

Reread your notes: what actually happened? Compare to the version imposed on you.

→ *My notes are reliable — I can lean on them.*

Trusting yourself again

Trusting yourself again means relearning to listen to your feelings without disqualifying them. If something hurt or bothered you, your feeling is valid information.

You have the right to believe yourself.

Example

Léa stopped asking 'am I exaggerating?' and started asking 'what am I feeling right now?'. It changed everything.

My valid feelings

Write 3 situations where your feeling was legitimate, even if it was denied.

My anchoring line

A line to tell yourself: e.g. 'What I feel is valid information.'

→ *I have the right to believe myself and trust my feelings.*

Building support to get out

Gaslighting collapses in the light of a trusted outside view. Talking to a loved one, a professional, a specialized service gives you back reliable bearings — and breaks the isolation manipulation relies on.

You don't have to untangle this alone.

Example

Telling the facts to a trusted friend, Sofia heard: 'no, you're not making anything up'. The doubt receded.

My outside view

Whom that I trust can I tell the facts to (loved one, professional, service)?

My first step

Pick a person or a service to contact this week.

→ *A trusted outside view breaks the fog.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Gaslighting makes you doubt your perception: you're not the problem.
- Note the facts right after (in a safe place): it's your anchor.
- Relearn to ask 'what am I feeling?', not 'am I exaggerating?'.
- Talk to a trusted person: an outside view clears the fog.
- A specialized service can help you name it and protect yourself.
- Your feelings and your memory are valid.

To fill in

Anchoring journal

Date	What was said/done	The version imposed on me

My valid feelings

The situation	My legitimate feeling

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Recognize the doubt installed in me.

Week 2 — Rebuild my perception through facts.

Week 3 — Trust myself again.

Week 4 — Surround myself with a reliable view.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The sentence that made me doubt:
- The fact my notes confirm:
- The trusted person I tell:

TO CLOSE

You have the right to believe yourself — your perception is yours.

You have the right to believe yourself.

This guide helps you recognize and name what you're living: it's a psychoeducation tool, not therapy or legal advice. If you're in immediate danger, call your local emergency number. To be heard and guided, reach out to a domestic-abuse or victim-support helpline in your country — most are free and confidential. You're not alone, and none of this is your fault. ©

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